Chat History

Match-Three Gem project · Claude Code session

USER

Read the README file in the project repository. Note down all the tasks present in it.

The first bug has been fixed, but before moving ahead, i want you to verify once if the fix was correct in the latest commit.

For the remaining tasks i want you to list them and add the features one by one, not all at once. Before moving on to the next feature, i want you to test the code for errors and then let me check it once for functional integrity.

CLAUDE

Task 4 (the idle hint) is in, and all my tests pass along with the earlier Task 1–3 checks. I haven't committed it; it's ready for you to try.

How it works

- **When it shows:** after 5 seconds with no input, two neighbouring gems that can be swapped to make a match get a pulsing gold outline and a soft white shimmer.
- **What counts as input:** any click (even outside the board) or pressing R hides the hint and restarts the 5-second countdown.
- **Falling gems:** the countdown doesn't start until gems stop falling, so the hint never appears mid-cascade. It's also hidden once the game is over.
- **No moves left:** the board checks for a move only once per idle period. If there isn't one, no hint appears and it doesn't keep re-checking every frame.

What changed

`board.py`:

- `find_hint()` tries every pair of neighbouring gems, swapping each pair in and back out to see if it would make a match.
- `render_hint()` draws the pulsing outline and shimmer.
- A new `hint` field is cleared on restart.

`game_engine.py`:

- `HINT_DELAY_MS = 5000` sets the delay; change it if you want the hint faster or slower.
- `register_input()` restarts the countdown and hides the hint.
- `update()` handles the timing.

Testing

- **Finding hints:** on 500 random boards, every hint was a real neighbouring pair that makes a match, and the search never changed the board. On a board with no possible moves it correctly returned nothing.
- **Timing:** using a simulated clock, I checked that:
  - nothing appears at 4 s and the hint appears after 5 s;

- a click hides it and restarts the 5 seconds;
- falling gems hold the countdown;
- there's no hint after the game ends;
- restarting clears it;
- the search runs once per idle period.

- **Visual:** I captured a screenshot with the hint showing. It highlighted a blue gem and the orange gem below it; swapping them lines the orange up with two others.

To try it

```
python main.py
```

Wait about 5 seconds without clicking.

This was the last task in the README. Once you've confirmed it plays well and committed, all four are done. Your submission still needs the before and after videos.

USER

the hint may seem unnoticeable because its very light. please make the hints have more contrast

CLAUDE

The current hint is a thin gold border plus a faint white overlay, which barely shows up on yellow and orange gems. Making it stronger:

- a dark outline around the outside so it stands out from any gem colour;
- a thicker border that pulses between bright gold and white and grows slightly with each pulse;
- a stronger white shimmer over the gem.

Ran a command, read 2 files

The hint is much more visible now. The only change is `render_hint()` in `board.py`; all the earlier tests still pass.

	Before	Now
Border	2–4 px gold	5 px, pulsing between bright gold and white
Outline	none	3 px black ring around the border
Size	fixed	grows a few pixels on each pulse
White shimmer over the gem	30–100 opacity	60–160 opacity
Pulse speed	200 ms	180 ms, a little faster

I saved screenshots at both ends of the pulse:

- **At its dimmest:** a thick gold ring. It even shows up on a yellow gem, because the black outline separates it from the gem colour.
- **At its brightest:** a white ring with a strong white wash over the gem. The two highlighted gems stand out clearly from everything around them.

> Your Task 4 changes are still staged but not committed. This contrast change is unstaged on top of them, so you can commit them together or separately.
>
> **To check it**
>
> ```
> python main.py
> ```
>
> Wait about 5 seconds without clicking.
>
> If it’s still too subtle or now too strong, I can tune the line thickness, how much it grows, or the colours.